

*Start 5 minutes before game time. Ensure all coaches attend (non-optional).*

“Good afternoon, I’m your umpire today. Please address me as Blue, Sir, or Umpire. I am human, and will do the best that I can to make the calls as I see them. Let’s go over the ground rules:

- Ensure players’ jerseys are tucked, and they demonstrate good sportsmanship
- Remind your team to hustle on and off the field in order to keep the game moving.
- Pitchers get 5 warm-up pitches between innings, 8 for fresh pitchers.
- Swearing or throwing equipment results in an ejection. Arguing judgment calls or balls/strikes isn’t allowed.
- Strike zone: 2 inches below knees to top of shoulders, extending 4 inches either side of the plate for 10U, 2 inches for 12U.
- For rule clarifications, bring the rulebook between innings for a calm discussion. Ranting coaches will be returned to the dugout; continued disruption leads to ejection, and play will stop until the offending coach has left the field.
- Coaches, handle disruptive spectators. Persistent issues pause the game until resolved.
- Let’s review the field: boundaries, in/out of play, and dead ball areas. Questions?
- Let’s have a safe, fun game! Good luck to both teams.